Volume I

World Canon, Metaphysics & Continental Topography

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Volume I Synopsis

Cosmic neutrality of Lux and Tenebris, chivalric Kingdom of Sacyra, continental realms, and the existential menace of The Dark Lord.

Chapter 1. The Primordial Neutrality of Lux and Tenebris

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1.1. Canonical Introduction

This document establishes the living world-building canon, cosmological ontology, and historical epic of **Tenebris and Lux** ("Darkness and Light"). Conceived between 2014–2018 in RPG Maker as the premier game of **CreativeWorkzStudio**, this is the epic of two primordial relics—**The Shield of Lux** and **The Sword of Tenebris**—set within the storied **Kingdom of Sacyra** (pronounced **"saw-kee-ruh"**, `/s□□□ki□r□/`). The story is driven by a tri-perspective narrative architecture: **Elijah Ro-enheart**, son of a former head of the Royal Guard; **Lady Katrina Jaren**, an aristocratic daughter seeking autonomy in the Adventurers' Guild; and the customizable **Bearer** (`<chosen_name>`), as the re-awakening **Dark Lord** rises from the subterranean abyss and **King Jihad** plots treason on the High Throne.

1.2. The Primordial Cosmology: Neutrality of the Apex Forces

> "Light without shadow is a blinding desert that calcifies the spirit. Shadow without light is a suffocating void where purpose drowns. The Shield preserves and confines; the Sword severs and liberates. The relics know neither virtue nor malice—only the soul that wields them."
>
> — The Sacyran Chronicle of Antiquity

In the cosmology of **Tenebris and Lux**, the cosmos is governed by two apex forces that transcend mortal morality. Neither is inherently good nor evil:

1.2.1. Lux (The Apex of Radiance & Cohesion)

- **Ontological Essence:** Manifestation, illumination, cohesion, preservation, temporal anchoring, and structure.
- **The Dual Nature of Light:**
  - **Virtuous Manifestation:** Projects golden protective barriers (**Lux Barrio**), wards the vulnerable, preserves cultural heritage, and seeks peace through reconciliation.
  - **Tyrannical Manifestation:** Scorches the earth in unyielding glare, blinding dissenters, enforcing calcifying stasis, denying natural growth and mortality, and petrifying living will into stone.

1.2.2. Tenebris (The Apex of Darkness & Severance)

- **Ontological Essence:** Mystery, dissolution, rest, severance, finality, and the fertile void.
- **The Dual Nature of Darkness:**
  - **Virtuous Manifestation:** Cuts through tyrant armor (**Cuttatio Tenebris**), severs corrupt bindings, veils the oppressed from predators, and executes swift, surgical **Absolute Justice**.
  - **Malevolent Manifestation:** Spreads entropic rot, dissolves conscience into nihilism, feeds bitter vengeance, and fuels tyrannical conquest.

1.2.3. The Law of Tempering and Dissipation

The relationship between Lux and Tenebris is governed by a strict metaphysical law: * **Lux as the Singular**

Tempering Agent: Raw Tenebris is entropic and severing; left unchecked, it erodes everything it touches. Lux is the only force capable of containing and tempering Tenebris, providing structural cohesion so that the void's cutting edge can be safely directed. * **The Fragility of Radiance (Dissipation):** While Lux tempers Tenebris, it requires steadfast emotional and ethical harmony. Any sudden, violent surge of fear, wrath, or malice causes Lux to **dissipate immediately**, collapsing protective barriers and leaving Tenebris unbridled.

1.2.4. The Moral Sway Continuum ([-100, +100]) & 13-Tier Taxonomy

Neither Lux nor Tenebris dictates a character's morality. Good and evil belong entirely to the **intent, conscience, and choices of the heart behind the weapon**, tracked along the `[-100, +100]` **Moral Sway** axis via the **Compass of Morality**. A knight channeling blinding radiance can act as a calcified tyrant, while an outrider wielding the void-edged blade of Tenebris can stand as the people's ultimate savior.

The continuum is codified into a formal 13-tier canonical nomenclature:

Integer Range / Point	Canonical Designation	Functional Definition
`-100`	**The Sovereign of Ruin**	Absolute negative terminus. Total surrender to abyssal nihilism or petrifying totalitarianism.
`[-100, -50]`	**Active Malice (The Tyrannical Sphere)**	Deliberate cruelty, ruthless execution, and despotic dominion.
`[-50, 0]`	**Cynical Pragmatism (Compliant Apathy)**	Lower bystander band. Self-serving opportunism, petty theft, and systemic complicity.
`0`	**The Stance of Equilibrium (Harmonic Zero)**	Active, disciplined synthesis where Lux and Tenebris temper one another without stasis or rot.
`[0, +50]`	**Conventional Decency (Uncommitted Virtue)**	Upper bystander band. Civic compliance that avoids personal risk to challenge corruption.
`[+50, +100]`	**Active Virtue (The Restorative Sphere)**	Self-sacrificing heroism, surgical liberation, and restorative justice breaking inertia.
`+100`	**The Saint of Mercy**	Absolute positive terminus. Unyielding altruism in protection (Lux) or pure Absolute Justice (Tenebris).
`[-50, +50]`	**The Bystander Corridor**	Net Moral Inertia; zone of mutual cancellation where history repeats itself.
`[-100, 0]`	**The Arc of Dissolution**	The deconstructive hemisphere of the world ledger (Tyranny & Ruin).
`[0, +100]`	**The Arc of Restoration**	The constructive hemisphere of the world ledger (Virtue & Mercy).
`[-50, +100]`	**The Transcending Mortal Arc**	Trajectory of overcoming cynicism or blind obedience to achieve heroic conviction.
`[-100, +50]`	**The Arc of Tragic Disillusionment**	Trajectory of a betrayed soul whose optimism is capped at cautious neutrality, plunging to the abyss.

Integer Range / Point	Canonical Designation	Functional Definition
`[-100, +100]`	**The Universal Ledger**	The complete canvas of mortal free will (The Compass of Morality).

1.2.5. Character Categorization Across the Continuum

Range / Point	Canonical Designation	Historical Figures (Past)	Campaign Figures (Present)	Ludonarrative Rationale
`-100`	**Sovereign of Ruin**	**Usuru (Late Era)**	**The Dark Lord**	Consumed by unhealed grief after discovering the 11th Festival stasis deception.
`[-100, -50]`	**Active Malice**	*Six-Faction Warlords*	**King Jihad** (\~ -85)	Issues royal gag orders and plots to usurp the Dark Lord's void essence behind a benevolent facade.
`[-50, 0]`	**Cynical Pragmatism**	*Ancient Court Bailiffs*	**The St. Baron** (\~ -45), **Katrina Jaren (Base)** (\~ -20)	The St. Baron exploits Lower Dio through debt bondage. Katrina begins here: sardonic, hunting for Grandma's will to escape Dio.
`[-30, +30]`	**The Provincial Swing**	*Border Smugglers*	**John the Thief**	Operates in Lower Dio's gray margins, balancing illegal theft against community survival.
`0`	**Stance of Equilibrium**	*The Sages of Old*	**Chrono the Sage**	Anchored outside temporal degradation in the Room of Sages within the Dreamscape.
`[0, +50]`	**Conventional Decency**	**Usuru (Youth)** (\~ +30)	**Eric the Lumberjack** (\~ +10), **Elijah Ro-enheart (Base)** (\~ +35)	Honest folk surviving day-to-day. Elijah starts as a polite, rule-bound soldier hesitant to violate protocol.
`[+50, +100]`	**Active Virtue**	**Prince Mi-ren**, **Prince Casatti**, **The First King**	**Grandma Magolia**, **Sir Roté**, **Monica the Mystic**	Figures defined by communal protection, sacrificial defense, and devotion to peace.
`+100`	**Saint of Mercy**	**Goddess Lyri** (Ideal)	*Endgame Player Potential*	Theoretical pinnacle of pure self-sacrifice and uncorrupted justice.
`[-50, +100]`	**Transcending Mortal Arc**	*Academy Reformers*	**Elijah Ro-enheart (Arc)**, **Katrina Jaren (Arc)**	Elijah transcends blind obedience into conscience; Katrina refines rebellious cynicism into noble sacrifice.

Range / Point	Canonical Designation	Historical Figures (Past)	Campaign Figures (Present)	Ludonarrative Rationale
`[-100, +50]`	**Tragic Disillusionment**	**Usuru (Full Trajectory)**	*Compromised Playthrough*	Faith shattered in his 11th year, plunging from innocent reverence (+30) to the abyss (-100).
`[-100, +100]`	**The Unwritten Slate**	**Prince Mi-ren (Burden)**	**The Custom Bearer (`<chosen_name>`)**	Awakens at 0 in the Dreamscape; carries Mi-ren's macro-stewardship across the entire moral spectrum.

1.3. Genesis: The Mundane Inception & The Two Princes

1.3.1. The Mundane Armaments of Inception

At the founding of the Kingdom of Sacyra, the Shield of Lux and Sword of Tenebris were forged as ordinary, non-magical weapons of steel and silver by royal smiths, presented to the First King as civic emblems: * **The Mundane Shield:** Represented **Peace**, communal defense, and internal harmony. * **The Mundane Sword:** Represented **War**, territorial justice, and border vigilance.

1.3.2. The Self-Running Systems

The First King was deeply beloved by his subjects across all provinces. Under his leadership, the realm's civic, legal, and municipal systems were engineered so effectively that the kingdom practically governed itself. Personal royal audiences were required only "once in a blue moon".

1.3.3. The Ideological Fork

The First King had two teenage sons who divided the responsibilities of civilization: * **Prince Mi-ren:** The elder son and heir to the High Throne, raised in statecraft to preserve his father's peace. * **Prince Casatti:** The younger son, who voluntarily renounced the throne to establish **The Academy**, an independent institution dedicated to natural philosophy, elemental sciences, and mapping **The Dreamscape**.

1.4. The 11th Festival Rupture & The 7-Year Great War

1.4.1. The Coma and the Silent Vigil (Festivals 1–10)

Following the first week-long **Festival of Peoples**, the First King fell into a coma, though his consciousness remained awake across the gossamer veil in **The Dreamscape**. When his physical body passed away during the 5th Festival, teenage Mi-ren and Casatti maintained a protective vigil: using the annual thinned-veil festival week to commune with the First King's spirit and project him into the temporal world in short bursts until Mi-ren was officially "of age."

1.4.2. Usuru and the 11th Year Catastrophe

In the 11th year, an eleven-year-old wanderer from remote Libira (a frontier kingdom suffering from a seven-day courier delay and no relay outposts) snuck into the royal sanctum to see the "plagued" king. Discovering the mummified corpse and projection array, the shocked boy accidentally tampered with the ritual: 1. The spiritual tether snapped, permanently sealing the First King in The Dreamscape. 2. The violent shift in the boy's heart caused an

unprecedented metaphysical surge that birthed **Tenebris** into waking reality. 3. The planar backlash physically warped continental distances between Libira and the Capital. 4. Taking the name **Usuru**, the youth led Libira and neighboring border realms in a war of annexation against the Capital.

1.4.3. The 7-Year Great War & The Awakening of the Relics

Usuru's uprising ignited **The Great War** across six fractured powers: The Capital, Libira, Great Mau, Old Sacyra, The Academy, and the Yun-yin Provinces: * **Casatti's Infusion of Tenebris:** Prince Casatti isolated the anomalous void energy and infused it into the mundane Sword of War to execute **Absolute Justice** and end the war swiftly. * **Mi-ren's Discovery of Lux:** Prince Mi-ren adapted the temporal projection technique to discover **Lux**, infusing it into the mundane Shield of Peace with a mandate of **atonement and forgiveness for Usuru**. * **The Accord of Kings:** Lux tempered Tenebris, bringing the war to an armistice in exactly **seven years**. The six powers ratified the **"Joint Realm, Separate Kingdoms"** accord, solidifying autonomous regional rule under the High Crown and enshrining the **Prophecy of Kings**. Refusing reconciliation, Usuru retreated into the abyssal vaults, degenerating over three millennia into **The Dark Lord**.

1.5. The 3,000-Year Dynastic Wave & Modern Sacyra

Between the Great War and the modern campaign lies a three-thousand-year chasm ($3,000\text{ years}$) spanning between **30 and 50 monarchs** (averaging $60\text{ to }100\text{ years}$ per reign):

- **The Succession Wave:** The dynasty cycled between Long Stasis Crests (60–90+ years of high peace and calcified bureaucracy), Tether-Sickness Troughs (5–20 years of royal paranoia and premature death near the High Throne's planar wound), and Bureaucratic Consolidations (35–50 years).
- **The Systemic Neglect:** Millennia of Capital stability fostered systemic apathy toward frontier settlements like **Dio Village**, replicating ancient Libira's "quiet complaint."
- **"The King's Curse" & King Jihad:** For three millennia, sovereigns on the High Throne were exposed to psychic backwash from the planar wound left by Usuru. Coveting void power, **King Jihad** opened himself to the abyss prior to the modern Festival of Heroes, resulting in possession by The Dark Lord's psychic remnant.

1.6. The Tri-Perspective Protagonists

The heart of **Tenebris and Lux** is an unfolding mystery navigated across three distinct vantage points:

1.6.1. Elijah Ro-enheart (The Vanguard of Lux)

- **Lineage & Heritage:** Son of legendary **Commander Gareth Ro-enheart**, former Head of the Royal Guard, who vanished under King Jihad's sealed orders on Elijah's 10th birthday.
- **Archetype & Role:** Frontline Heavy Vanguard / Fortress Anchor. Wields the **Shield of Lux**.
- **Thematic Parallel:** Mirrors ancient **Usuru** (The Frontier Wound). Endured a childhood frozen on his tenth year; raised with reverence for the Crown only to discover court betrayal. By choosing independent moral conscience over vengeance, Elijah represents Usuru granted redemptive grace.

1.6.2. Lady Katrina Jaren (The Outrider of Tenebris)

- **Lineage & Heritage:** Estranged daughter of aristocratic **House Jaren**, one of the wealthiest noble families on the Royal Court.
- **Archetype & Role:** High-Mobility Skirmisher / Flanking Striker. Wields the **Sword of Tenebris**.

- **Thematic Parallel:** Mirrors ancient **Prince Casatti** (The Renouncing Blade). Renounces aristocratic birthright in favor of the meritocratic **Adventurers' Guild**, wielding the sharp edge of Tenebris with cynical candor to slice through court hypocrisy and provincial stagnation.

1.6.3. The Custom Bearer (`<chosen_name>` — The Secret Chronicler)

- **Archetype & Role:** Emergent champion in Chrono's astral archives. Holds **The Dream Compass**.
- **Thematic Parallel:** Mirrors ancient **Prince Mi-ren** (The Steward of Balance). Decoupled from fixed identities, the player navigates the nocturnal Dreamscape trials, performing the "double work" to synthesize both Elijah's and Katrina's paths to unlock the **Secret Chronicler True Ending**.

1.7. The Tactical Strategy RPG (TRPG) Paradigm

Tenebris and Lux combines deep tactical planning with visceral action execution:

1. **Strategic 2D Grid Positioning:**
   - Multi-elevation grid maps across provinces, bridges, castles, and Dreamscape leylines.
   - Tactical movement budgets, Zone of Control (ZOC), flanking angles, and cover bonuses.
2. **Cinematic Combat Resolution:**
   - Initiating attacks transitions into dynamic traditional side-scroll / action duels.
   - Core skills: **Lux Barrio** (barrier rolls $2\dots5$ turns, 25% damage mitigation), **Cuttatio Tenebris** (20% splash cleave), and **Duo-Loca Bashin n Slash** (adaptive defense targeting).
3. **Ludonarrative Consent & Multi-Ending Resolution:**
   - Act I focuses on defeating King Jihad; Act II focuses on stopping The Dark Lord.
   - Players skipping nocturnal Dream Compass trials receive the **Neutral Ending** (saving Sacyra while leaving the First King marooned). Players achieving full synthesis unlock the canonical **True Ending** ("The Ugly Truth"), resolving three millennia of cosmic conflict.

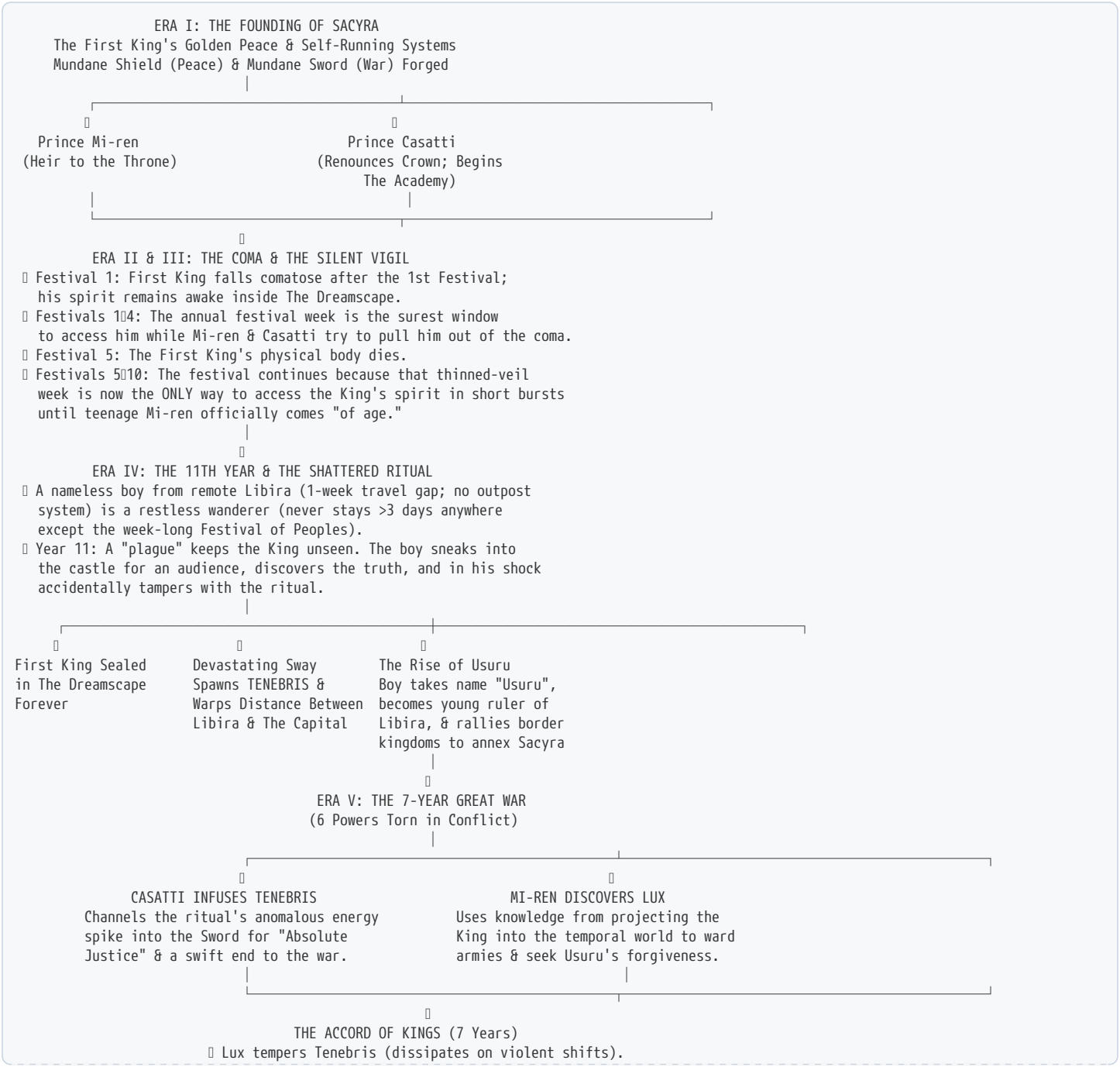
Chapter 2. Historical Canon & Macro-Chronology

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2.1. Overview & Historiographical Scope

This volume establishes the definitive historical canon, cosmological chronology, and dynastic chronicle of the **Kingdom of Sacyra** (pronounced **"saw-kee-ruh"**, /s□□□ki□r□/). Grounded in the authentic 2017–2018 demo archives and formal narrative architecture, it traces the 3,000-year continuum from the founding by the First King through the 7-Year Great War, the tragedy of Usuru, the awakening of the twin relics, the 3,000-year dynastic wave, and the modern crisis under King Jihad.

2.2. Chronological Epoch Map



```
                        Establishes "Joint Realm, Separate Kingdoms" politics.
                        Births the "Prophecy of Kings" around the twin relics.
                            |
                            
          THE 3,000-YEAR CHASM & DYNASTIC WAVE
               (30 50 Monarchs across 3 Millennia)
```

2.3. Era I: The Founding of Sacyra & The Two Princes

2.3.1. The Mundane Armaments of Inception

At the founding of the Kingdom of Sacyra, the **Shield of Lux** and the **Sword of Tenebris** were not magical or celestial artifacts. They were forged as ordinary, non-magical armaments of steel and silver by royal smiths, presented to the First King as civic symbols of statecraft:

- **The Mundane Shield:** Represented **Peace**, communal defense, and agricultural stability.
- **The Mundane Sword:** Represented **War**, territorial vigilance, and border law enforcement.

2.3.2. The Self-Running Systems of the First King

The First King was deeply beloved by his subjects across all provinces. Under his leadership, the kingdom's municipal, legal, and civic institutions were so well-engineered that the realm practically governed itself. Citizens did not lack access to the King out of tyranny or aloofness, but because the systems functioned with such frictionless harmony that a personal royal audience was required only "once in a blue moon".

2.3.3. The Ideological Fork: Mi-ren and Casatti

The First King had two sons who chose distinct paths while still young teenagers:

- **Prince Mi-ren (The Elder Son):** The rightful heir to the High Throne, raised in administrative discipline to inherit his father's covenant of golden peace.
- **Prince Casatti (The Younger Son):** Renounced his royal birthright to the throne to establish **The Academy**, dedicating his life to empirical inquiry, elemental sciences, and mapping the astral geometries of the ethereal plane.

2.4. Era II & III: The Festival of Peoples, The Coma & The Silent Vigil

2.4.1. Why the Festival Lasted a Full Week

Every year, the Capital hosted the **Festival of Peoples**—an international gathering where border demarcations were ratified, continental infrastructure treaties negotiated, and subjects celebrated. Rather than holding a single-day event, the First King mandated a full seven-day festival out of deliberate consideration for distant subjects: those with harvest or trade obligations could depart early, while delegations traveling from the furthest frontiers of the known world were guaranteed meaningful participation.

2.4.2. The First Festival Coma & Discovery of The Dreamscape

Immediately following the first grand Festival of Peoples—where the collective emotional consciousness of an entire continent converged—the First King collapsed into a deep coma. His body remained dormant, yet his spirit was fully lucid and awake on the other side of the ethereal boundary in **The Dreamscape**. By tracing his father's displaced consciousness, Prince Casatti and The Academy mapped the Dreamscape in full.

2.4.3. Festivals 1 Through 4: The Four-Year Rescue Effort

During the first four years of the coma, the annual festival week—when the boundary ("the Veil") thinned to gossamer—served as the **surest, most stable window** to access the King. Throughout these four years, Mi-ren, Casatti, and the court worked tirelessly across the thinned veil attempting to pull the First King back into his mortal body.

2.4.4. Era III: The 5th Festival Death & The Meaning of "Of Age"

During the **5th Festival of Peoples**, the First King's physical body died. Pulling him out of the coma was no longer possible. However, the Castle court continued the festival because that thinned-veil week was now the **sole remaining lifeline** allowing Mi-ren to commune with his father's lucid spirit and project his consciousness into the temporal hall in short bursts when rare royal audiences were needed.

This secret was maintained across Festivals 5 through 10 not out of malice, but as a protective vigil:

- **No Precedent for Succession:** Sacyra had never experienced the death of a monarch before; international peace treaties were bound to the First King's personal covenant, and no constitutional law existed for a regency.
- **The Chivalric Definition of "Of Age":** Mi-ren and Casatti were teenagers. In Sacyran chivalric law, attaining majority required martial maturity to personally command the Royal Guard alongside mastery of the Academy's statecraft systems so the self-running realm would not shatter under foreign pressure.

2.5. Era IV: Usuru the Wanderer & The 11th Year Tragedy

2.5.1. The "Quiet Complaint" of Remote Libira

Far on the southern frontier lay the **Kingdom of Libira**, a sparse, underdeveloped territory separated from the Capital by a grueling seven-day journey. Because Libira was not yet established enough to maintain an imperial relay outpost network, communications suffered a chronic seven-day lag. This systemic gap fostered a simmering **"quiet complaint"** among Libirans regarding the disparity between Capital prosperity and border isolation.

2.5.2. The Three-Day Wanderer

During the First King's peaceful reign, a boy was born in Libira to a humble family without being given a name. For ten years, he grew up traveling the continent as a restless wanderer who lived by a strict personal rule: **never stay more than three days anywhere**—except for the annual week-long Festival of Peoples in the Capital, which he attended with pure devotion to honor the King he revered.

2.5.3. The 11th Year Rupture

During the boy's eleventh annual pilgrimage to the festival, heralds announced that a "royal plague" kept the First King unseen on his balcony. Anxious for the monarch he adored, the eleven-year-old boy slipped past castle guards into the royal sanctum to seek an audience.

Inside, the boy discovered the long-dead body and Prince Mi-ren utilizing Academy projection glyphs. Lacking the statecraft context to understand the court's desperate vigil, the boy viewed the revelation as a monstrous, hypocritical deception. In his terror and shock, he accidentally collided with the ritual array, triggering four catastrophic consequences:

1. **The Eternal Astral Seal:** The First King's spiritual tether snapped; his consciousness was permanently marooned in **The Dreamscape**.
2. **The Birth of Tenebris:** The violent collapse of the boy's innocent faith into profound betrayal produced an

anomalous metaphysical shockwave, releasing the cosmic apex force of **Tenebris** (severance and dissolution) into the waking temporal world that very day.

3. **The Warped Distance:** The planar backwash physically warped continental leylines, stretching the geographical distance between Libira and the Capital into an unnatural chasm that the boy interpreted as an act of deliberate hostile separation by the Crown.
4. **The Rise of Sovereign Usuru:** Taking the name **Usuru**, the youth fled back to Libira, revealed the Capital's deception, was crowned young ruler of Libira, and rallied neighboring border kingdoms into an alliance to declare a war of total annexation against the Capital.

2.6. Era V: The 7-Year Great War & Awakening of the Relics

2.6.1. The Six Fractured Powers

Usuru's uprising ignited **The Great War**, plunging six sovereign powers into continental war:

Faction	Leadership	Strategic Role in the Conflict
The Libira Kingdom	Sovereign Usuru	Vanguard of the frontier coalition; driven by righteous betrayal and territorial annexation.
The Capital	Prince Mi-ren	Citadel defense of the High Throne, administrative continuity, and royal army deployment.
The Great Mau Kingdom	High Chieftains	Mighty inland territorial power maneuvering along contested eastern borders.
Old Sacyra	Traditional Fiefdoms	Ancestral heartland baronies fighting to preserve chivalric feudal order.
The Academy	Prince Casatti	Independent intellectual and arcane bastion deploying experimental elemental resonance.
The Yun-yin Provinces	Provincial Assemblies	Western agricultural riverlands caught between coalition supply routes and capital levies.

2.6.2. Casatti's Infusion of Tenebris (The Sword of War)

Determined to end Usuru's siege quickly and preserve the realm, Prince Casatti analyzed the anomalous energy spike recorded during the ritual rupture. Synthesizing his knowledge of the Dreamscape and elemental properties, Casatti isolated **Tenebris** and infused it into the mundane Sword of War. He forged the **Sword of Tenebris** not out of bloodlust, but to execute **Absolute Justice**—creating a surgical blade capable of severing siege lines and unyielding armor to halt the war decisively.

2.6.3. Mi-ren's Discovery of Lux (The Shield of Peace)

Taking command of the Capital's forces, Prince Mi-ren sought not conquest or vengeance, but **atonement and forgiveness from Usuru**. By reverse-engineering the projection ritual used to anchor ethereal concepts into physical reality, Mi-ren unlocked **Lux** (cohesion, preservation, and radiance) and infused it into the mundane Shield of Peace, creating the **Shield of Lux**.

2.6.4. The Law of Tempering and Dissipation

Battlefield confrontations between the two armaments revealed the foundational cosmic dynamic:

- **Lux as the Singular Tempering Agent:** Raw Tenebris is purely severing and entropic; left unchecked, it erodes both wielder and target. Lux is the only force capable of containing and stabilizing Tenebris, granting structural cohesion so void strikes can be directed with precision.
- **The Fragility of Radiance (Dissipation):** While Lux stabilizes Tenebris, its golden coherence requires steadfast emotional and ethical harmony. Any sudden surge of terror, wrath, or malice causes Lux to **dissipate instantly**, leaving Tenebris unbridled.

2.6.5. The Parley & The 7-Year Armistice

During peace negotiations, Prince Mi-ren lowered his defenses and offered total reconciliation to Usuru. However, Usuru's deep bitterness erupted in a violent surge of hatred, causing Mi-ren's ambient Lux aura to dissolve on the spot.

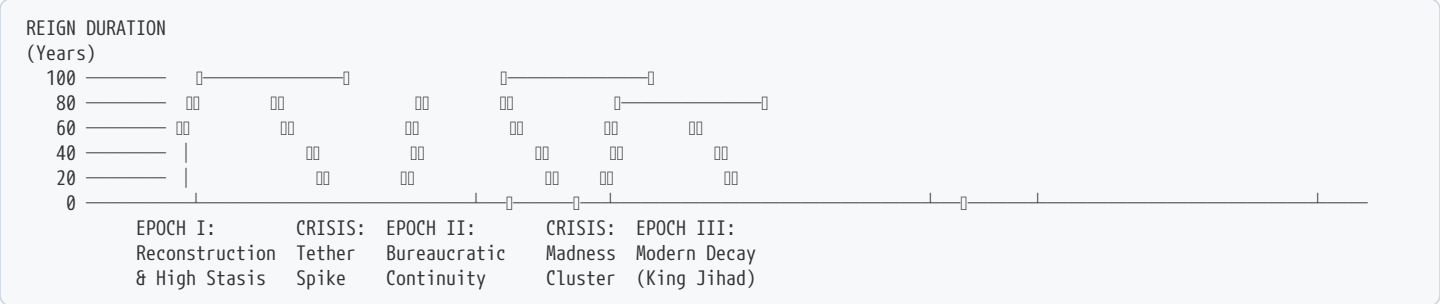
Recognizing that neither side could achieve unconditional victory without mutual annihilation, the six powers ratified the **Accord of Kings**, bringing the Great War to a close after exactly **seven years**:

- **"Joint Realm, Separate Kingdoms":** Autonomous provinces and kingdoms formed a loose federated realm under the High Crown while preserving regional self-rule.
- **The Prophecy of Kings:** Sages enshrined the legend that true peace would only return when a bearer achieved the **Stance of Equilibrium**, harmonizing the Shield and Sword without allowing wrath to dissipate the light.
- **Usuru's Descent:** Refusing reconciliation, Usuru retreated into the deep subterranean abyss, where his resentment festered over three millennia until his name was forgotten, remembered only as **The Dark Lord**.

2.7. The 3,000-Year Chasm & The Dynastic Wave

Between the Great War and the modern campaign lies a three-thousand-year chasm ($3,000\text{ years}$), spanning between **30 and 50 monarchs** (averaging $60\text{ to }100\text{ years}$ per reign).

2.7.1. The Mathematical Wave of Succession



The dynastic progression oscillates across three cyclical phases:

1. **Long Stasis Crests (60–90+ Years):** In eras of high stability, the First King's self-running institutions, Academy restorative arts, and the preserving aura of the Shield of Lux allowed monarchs to reign for nearly a century in peaceful continuity.
2. **Tether-Sickness Troughs (5–20 Years):** Succession clusters triggered when the dormant planar wound beneath the High Throne flared up, afflicting sovereigns with premature wasting, paranoia, and sudden abdications.
3. **Bureaucratic Consolidations (35–50 Years):** Standard generational transitions managed smoothly by the Royal Court and hereditary Noble Houses.

2.7.2. Five Axioms of Dynastic Continuity

Why does the narrative require an established 3,000-year dynastic order rather than constant civil anarchy?

1. **Embodying the Cosmological Shadow of Lux:** Unbroken continuity proves Sacyra succumbed to the negative extreme of Lux—calcifying stasis—transforming a golden peace into a rigid, bureaucratic museum.
2. **Exposing Frontier Neglect as Systemic:** Because the Capital enjoyed millennia of comfort, the decay of border settlements like **Dio Village** is exposed not as temporary wartime fallout, but as cold, institutional apathy mirroring ancient Libira.
3. **Isolating "The King's Curse":** In a stable, legally sacrosanct monarchy free of routine coups, the periodic madness afflicting sovereigns stands out as a haunting metaphysical anomaly.
4. **Validating the Ro-enheart Lineage:** Five unbroken generations of Ro-enheart leadership at the head of the Royal Guard holds sacred weight only if the crown they defended felt ancient, honorable, and permanent.
5. **Magnifying King Jihad's Rupture:** An established 3,000-year legacy transforms **King Jihad** (`D. Jihad`) from a common bad ruler into an existential traitor gambling away three millennia of peace for void supremacy.

Chapter 3. Master Storyboard Sequence (Scenes 01–20)

Source File: `docs/lore/master_storyboard_chronicle.adoc`

3.1. Overview & Cinematic Philosophy

This document contains the complete master storyboard sequence for the historical prologue and ancestral memory sequences of **Tenebris and Lux**. Comprising twenty sequentially numbered cinematic scenes (Scenes 01–20), this chronicle establishes the visual language, color temperature, character staging, and dramatic pacing that bridge the founding of the Kingdom of Sacyra to the catastrophe of the 11th Festival and the dawn of the Great War.

3.2. Cinematic Staging Matrix (Scenes 01–20)

Scene	Title	Setting & Tone	Visual Focus	Narrative & Thematic Action
01	**Symbols of Iron**	Royal Forges of Sacyra (Warm hearth amber)	Smiths quenching an unadorned steel kite-shield and broadsword.	The Kingdom of Sacyra is founded. Two ordinary weapons are presented to the First King as civic symbols of **Peace** and **War**.
02	**The Crown and the Scroll**	Sacyra Throne Room (Sunlit marble)	The First King with his teenage sons, Mi-ren and Casatti.	Mi-ren accepts his birthright as heir; Casatti declines the throne to establish **The Academy**.
03	**The Self-Running Realm**	Capital Courtyards & Provincial Towns (Golden calm)	Civic courts and markets running smoothly without royal interference.	Establishes a reign of peace so well-engineered that war is merely an idea and royal audiences are needed only once in a blue moon.
04	**The First Festival & The Coma**	Grand Festival Grounds / Royal Bedchamber	The known world celebrating for a full week; the First King collapsing into a coma as his spirit awakens in the Dreamscape.	The week-long Festival of Peoples accommodates distant travelers. Afterward, the King falls comatose; Casatti discovers the Dreamscape in full while tracking his father’s lucid spirit.
05	**The Four-Year Rescue Effort**	Academy Conduit Chamber (Festivals 1–4)	Teenage Mi-ren and Casatti working across the thinned festival veil to reach their father.	For four years, the festival week serves as the surest window to access the King while his sons attempt to pull him out of his coma.
06	**The Passing at the Fifth**	Royal Sanctum (Festival 5, solemn candlelight)	The First King’s physical body expiring while his golden silhouette remains across the veil.	The King dies during the 5th Festival. Because Mi-ren is not yet "of age" for the first succession, the Castle keeps the secret; the festival continues as the only way left to access the King in short bursts.

Scene	Title	Setting & Tone	Visual Focus	Narrative & Thematic Action
07	**The Quiet Complaint of Libira**	Frontier Kingdom of Libira (Windy, sparse roads)	A lone courier riding for seven days without a single relay outpost; a nameless boy born to a humble family.	Highlights the week-long travel gap and lack of an outpost system in Libira, breeding a "quiet complaint" over the Capital's distance.
08	**The Three-Day Wanderer**	Continental Roads & Capital Gates	Montage of the boy wandering from town to town (never staying past 3 days), except for his annual week at the Festival of Peoples.	For 10 years, the humble wanderer visits the Capital every festival week to celebrate and honor the First King.
09	**The Plague Year**	Festival Concourse — Year 11 (Somber crowd)	Heralds announcing a "plague" has struck the King; the 11-year-old boy looking at the empty royal balcony.	Unseen for the entire 11th festival, the King's absence worries the boy, prompting him to sneak into the castle for an audience.
10	**Behind the Veil**	Inner Castle Sanctum (Arcane glyphs, mist)	The boy discovering Mi-ren using Academy knowledge to commune with the long-dead First King.	From the boy's perspective, the Capital's golden peace is exposed as a years-long deception.
11	**The Shattered Ritual & Birth of Tenebris**	Inner Sanctum (Violent violet and gold shockwave)	Shocked, the boy accidentally tampers with the ritual; the tether snaps and a dark energy spike erupts.	The First King is sealed forever in **The Dreamscape**. The devastating shift in the boy's heart spawns **Tenebris** and warps the physical distance between Libira and the Capital.
12	**The Rise of Sovereign Usuru**	Libira Assembly Hall (Torchlight, raised spears)	The boy takes the name **Usuru**, rallying Libira's quiet complaints into open fury.	Seeing the warped distance as intentional malice, Usuru convinces Libira to crown him young ruler and declare a war of annexation against the Capital, inciting neighboring kingdoms to join.
13	**The Six-Power Conflagration**	Continental War Map (Six burning fronts)	Armies clashing across Libira, the Capital, Great Mau, Old Sacyra, the Academy, and the Yun-yin Provinces.	**The Great War** engulfs the known world.

Scene	Title	Setting & Tone	Visual Focus	Narrative & Thematic Action
14	**The Infusion of Tenebris**	Academy Arcane Forge (Deep twilight violet)	Prince Casatti channeling the anomalous energy spike from the interrupted ritual into the mundane Sword of War.	Synthesizing his study of the Dreamscape, world elements, and the rupture spike, Casatti creates the **Sword of Tenebris** to enact swift **Absolute Justice**.
15	**The General of Reconciliation**	Capital Command Tent (Warm lantern light)	Prince Mi-ren taking command of the army, vowing to seek Usuru's forgiveness.	Mi-ren leads the defense not for conquest, but to restore peace and mend the broken trust with Usuru.
16	**The Discovery of Lux**	Academy Spire & Battlefield (Golden radiance)	Mi-ren adapting the temporal projection ritual into a golden defensive barrier (**Lux**), sparking the Magic vs. Science debate.	Using what he learned from projecting the King into the temporal world, Mi-ren infuses the mundane Shield of Peace into the **Shield of Lux**.
17	**Tempering the Void**	Frontlines of the Great War (Gold & violet clash)	Mi-ren's Lux barrier containing and stabilizing Casatti's Tenebris strikes against coalition lines.	Demonstrates that Lux is the only force able to temper Tenebris, bringing the continental war to a decisive end in just **7 years**.
18	**The Dissipation at Parley**	Border Truce Grounds (Thick mist)	Mi-ren offering reconciliation to Usuru; Usuru's violent surge of hatred causing the ambient Lux to dissolve.	Proves the metaphysical law: any violent emotional shift causes Lux to dissipate instantly, just as it did on the day of the ritual rupture.
19	**The Joint Realm Accord**	Grand Council Chamber (Six regional banners)	Leaders ratifying the treaty establishing the "Joint Realm, Separate Kingdoms" political order.	Solidifies the federated geopolitical structure that persists into the modern era of Sacyra.
20	**The Prophecy of Kings**	Room of Sages / Royal Archives	Chrono recording the legend of the twin artifacts awaiting a bearer of true Equilibrium.	The First King's symbols of Peace and War are enshrined in the **Prophecy of Kings**, while Usuru retreats into the dark to become **The Dark Lord**.

3.3. Scene-by-Scene Narrative Walkthrough

3.3.1. Scene 01: Symbols of Iron

- **Atmosphere:** An ancient blacksmith workshop bathed in the deep amber glow of coal embers. Hammers strike rhythmic, resonant beats on an anvil.
- **Cinematics:** Steam hisses violently as a plain, unadorned kite shield and a straight broadsword are pulled from water troughs. There are no glowing runes, no magical stones, and no celestial sigils.
- **Thematic Grounding:** Sacyra's founding armaments were forged by mortal hands as mundane civic symbols of Peace and War. Power did not reside in the iron; it resided in the covenant of the sovereign who held them.

3.3.2. Scene 02: The Crown and the Scroll

- **Atmosphere:** High-vaulted marble halls of Sacyra Castle flooded with pure morning sunlight.
- **Cinematics:** The First King, majestic and warm, speaks with his two teenage sons. Prince Mi-ren kneels to receive the ceremonial signet of succession. Prince Casatti stands erect, clutching parchment scrolls and an astrolabe, smiling as he formally declines the throne to establish The Academy.
- **Thematic Grounding:** Establishes the harmonious brotherhood between governance (Mi-ren) and empirical inquiry (Casatti) before history fractured.

3.3.3. Scene 03: The Self-Running Realm

- **Atmosphere:** Vast panoramic shots of bustling provincial markets, lush terraced farms, and judicial courtyards under clear azure skies.
- **Cinematics:** Merchants trade freely; magistrates resolve disputes with open books; no armed patrols or royal inquisitors hover in the shadows. The throne room stands empty not from neglect, but because the machinery of state functions flawlessly.

3.3.4. Scene 04: The First Festival & The Coma

- **Atmosphere:** The vibrant, colorful sprawl of the inaugural Festival of Peoples.
- **Cinematics:** Seven days of joyous celebration give way to silence in the royal bedchamber. The First King collapses as the music fades. The camera slowly pushes past his dormant physical eyes into a starry, gossamer void: his consciousness stands upright, alive and lucid in The Dreamscape.

3.3.5. Scene 05: The Four-Year Rescue Effort

- **Atmosphere:** The dim, arcane candlelight of an Academy laboratory conduit chamber.
- **Cinematics:** For four consecutive years during festival week, teenage Mi-ren and Casatti channel glowing ether arrays toward their father’s spectral silhouette across the thinned veil, desperately trying to pull him back into physical reality.

3.3.6. Scene 06: The Passing at the Fifth

- **Atmosphere:** Cold, somber blue candlelight in the royal sanctum.
- **Cinematics:** The First King’s mortal chest draws its final breath; his physical heart ceases. Yet across the gossamer veil, his golden silhouette remains awake. The Castle ministers and the teenage princes lower their heads in solemn consensus: the vigil must continue until Mi-ren is of age.

3.3.7. Scene 07: The Quiet Complaint of Libira

- **Atmosphere:** Bleak, windswept savanna and rugged canyons of the remote southern frontier.
- **Cinematics:** A lone royal courier gallops past solitary marker stones under scorching sun and freezing night, taking seven grueling days to reach an isolated frontier village without a single relay outpost. In a humble thatch hut, a nameless baby is born.

3.3.8. Scene 08: The Three-Day Wanderer

- **Atmosphere:** A dynamic, fast-paced montage across muddy trade roads, dusty inns, and river barges.
- **Cinematics:** The growing boy arrives in hamlets, helps villagers for three days, packs his light sack on dawn of the

fourth day, and departs. He stays nowhere longer than three days—until the camera tracks him entering the golden gates of the Capital for the annual week-long Festival of Peoples.

3.3.9. Scene 09: The Plague Year

- **Atmosphere:** Chilly autumn mist hanging over a muted, uneasy festival concourse in the 11th year.
- **Cinematics:** Royal heralds announce from the battlement that the King has been stricken with illness and will not appear. The eleven-year-old boy stares up at the empty balcony with furrowed brows and rising dread.

3.3.10. Scene 10: Behind the Veil

- **Atmosphere:** Claustrophobic, echoing shadows of the forbidden inner keep.
- **Cinematics:** The boy slips through heavy oak doors into the projection chamber, watching from behind a stone pillar as Mi-ren chants over the long-dead, mummified body of the First King, projecting his spectral double onto the temporal dias. The boy's eyes widen in sheer horror at what he perceives as a monstrous fraud.

3.3.11. Scene 11: The Shattered Ritual & Birth of Tenebris

- **Atmosphere:** A blinding, violent detonation of midnight-violet and solar-gold.
- **Cinematics:** Tripping in his panic, the boy stumbles into the chalk glyphs and crystal anchors. The ethereal tether snaps with the sound of cracking glass; the First King is pulled backwards into the astral deep. From the boy's chest erupts an anomalous spike of pure cosmic void: **Tenebris** enters waking reality.

3.3.12. Scene 12: The Rise of Sovereign Usuru

- **Atmosphere:** The smoky, torchlit Great Hall of Libira.
- **Cinematics:** Standing before tribal chiefs and town elders, the youth raises a spear, his voice ringing with cold fury. He proclaims his name: **Usuru**. Spears clash against shields as Libira crowns their young sovereign and pledges to march on the Capital.

3.3.13. Scene 13: The Six-Power Conflagration

- **Atmosphere:** A vast tactical war table transitioning into panoramic battlefields lit by burning trebuchets.
- **Cinematics:** Six banners clash across smoking battlefields: Libira, The Capital, Great Mau, Old Sacyra, The Academy, and Yun-yin. Sacyra's golden peace dissolves into total war.

3.3.14. Scene 14: The Infusion of Tenebris

- **Atmosphere:** The subterranean resonance forge of The Academy.
- **Cinematics:** Prince Casatti holds the mundane iron broadsword over a crystal crucible containing the harvested violet rift energy. Chanting harmonic formulas, he quenches the steel in void essence. The blade turns star-black with rippling violet mist: the **Sword of Tenebris** is born for Absolute Justice.

3.3.15. Scene 15: The General of Reconciliation

- **Atmosphere:** The somber, parchment-strewn command tent of the Royal Army.
- **Cinematics:** Prince Mi-ren inspects defensive troop dispositions. He speaks to his captains not of conquest or retaliation, but of holding the line so that he may face Usuru and beg for his forgiveness.

3.3.16. Scene 16: The Discovery of Lux

- **Atmosphere:** An open battlefield at dawn, bathed in blinding celestial gold.
- **Cinematics:** Facing an enemy barrage, Mi-ren steps to the front ranks and raises the mundane iron shield. Channelling the memory of his father's temporal projection, radiant golden light solidifies into a geometric barrier: **Lux** manifests to shield the living.

3.3.17. Scene 17: Tempering the Void

- **Atmosphere:** A violent clash of solar-gold and abyssal-violet along the forward redoubts.
- **Cinematics:** Casatti's vanguard unleashes the severing edge of Tenebris, cutting through enemy siege engines, while Mi-ren's radiant Lux barrier contains the destructive blast wave. The two forces synchronize: Lux tempers Tenebris, bringing decisive victory in seven short years.

3.3.18. Scene 18: The Dissipation at Parley

- **Atmosphere:** A desolate borderland shrouded in thick morning mist.
- **Cinematics:** Mi-ren stands before Usuru with shield lowered, offering his hand and admitting the Crown's fault. Usuru's face twists with bitter, unyielding hatred. As Usuru roars in fury, Mi-ren's golden Lux barrier flickers and instantly dissolves into thin air, proving that violence in the heart shatters the light.

3.3.19. Scene 19: The Joint Realm Accord

- **Atmosphere:** The Grand Council Chamber in the reconstructed Capital.
- **Cinematics:** Envoys from all six sovereign factions sign their seals upon parchment treaties. The federated principle of "Joint Realm, Separate Kingdoms" is ratified, ensuring autonomous provincial governance under the High Crown.

3.3.20. Scene 20: The Prophecy of Kings

- **Atmosphere:** The timeless, floating crystalline library of the Room of Sages.
- **Cinematics:** Chrono the Sage dips a quill of starlight into an inkwell of void, recording the prophecy of the twin relics and the champion who must one day achieve Equilibrium. In the final shot, Usuru descends down stone stairs into the abyssal vaults, as shadow consumes his silhouette and history forgets his name, calling him only **The Dark Lord**.

Chapter 4. The Past, Present & Future Thematic Triad

Source File: `docs/lore/thematic_triad.adoc`

4.1. Overview & Core Thesis

Rather than mapping protagonists solely by the physical armaments they carry, the narrative architecture of **Tenebris and Lux** links the ancient genesis era to the modern campaign through a psychological triad: **Elijah is to Usuru**, **Katrina is to Prince Casatti**, and **The Custom Bearer (`<chosen_name>`) is to Prince Mi-ren**. Governed by the foundational axiom **"Trauma is Inherited, Destiny is Chosen,"** this document establishes how ancient grievances echo into the modern campaign and how player agency determines whether history repeats its tragedies or achieves cosmic reconciliation.

4.2. The Thematic Triad Matrix

Era	The Frontier Wound (Heart & Shield/Wrath)	The Renouncing Blade (Truth & Severance)	The Steward of Balance (Veil & Synthesis)
PAST (Genesis Era)	**Usuru** • Neglected Libiran boy • 10 years of peace; shattered in year 11 • Birthed Tenebris; became The Dark Lord	**Prince Casatti** • Renounced the High Throne • Founded The Academy • Infused Sword of Tenebris for Justice	**Prince Mi-ren** • Bore the burden of statecraft • Sustained the Dreamscape projection • Discovered Lux for reconciliation
PRESENT (Campaign)	**Elijah Ro-enheart** • Neglected Dio Village vanguard • Father vanished on 10th birthday • Wields Shield of Lux against court rot	**Lady Katrina Jaren** • Fled aristocratic House Jaren • Seeks the Adventurers' Guild • Wields Sword of Tenebris with candor	**The Custom Bearer (`<chosen_name>`)** • Emergent champion in the Archives • Wields the Dream Compass at night • Synthesizes both perspectives
FUTURE (Resolution)	**Redemption or Ruin** • Protects the realm with conscience, or succumbs to disillusionment.	**Liberation or Cynicism** • Cuts the planar bindings of the past, or embraces ruthless severance.	**Stasis or Equilibrium** • Repeats the comfortable lie, or confronts the Ugly Truth.

4.3. Elijah Ro-enheart as Usuru (The Frontier Wound & Redemptive Counterpoint)

Although Elijah wields the **Shield of Lux** like Prince Mi-ren, his internal wound and psychological arc directly mirror **Usuru**:

4.3.1. The Child of the Forgotten Frontier

Usuru grew up on the neglected periphery of Libira, where royal couriers required seven days to arrive and no imperial outposts existed. Elijah grows up in **Dio Village**, an isolated border settlement where Grandma Magolia laments: *"This town used to be full of life... The kingdom doesn't pay much attention to this place anymore"*. Both youths embody the quiet complaint of the forgotten border.

4.3.2. The Tenth-Year Fracture

Usuru experienced ten years of innocent pilgrimage to the Festival of Peoples before his eleventh visit shattered his faith in the Crown. Elijah's childhood similarly froze on his **10th birthday**—the morning his father, **Commander Gareth Ro-enheart**, vanished under King Jihad's sealed royal orders. When Grandma Magolia asks Elijah to inspect the upstairs chest in Dio Village, Elijah immediately clings to that decade-old wound: *"Maybe it is something about dad! I haven't seen him since my 10th birthday. Sure thing. This might be my chance to get answers!"*.

4.3.3. The Redemptive Choice

When Usuru discovered the First King's mummified body and the secret stasis projection, his innocent faith collapsed into bitter wrath, birthing Tenebris and sparking a war of vengeance. Elijah begins with unquestioning faith in the Royal Guard, but is forced to uncover King Jihad's treason in the throne room. Rather than succumbing to destructive malice, Elijah chooses to raise the **Shield of Lux** to protect the vulnerable, serving as Usuru granted a second chance at moral redemption.

4.4. Lady Katrina Jaren as Prince Casatti (The Renouncing Blade of Truth)

Lady Katrina Jaren carries the **Sword of Tenebris**, but her ideological kinship belongs to **Prince Casatti**:

4.4.1. Renouncing Aristocratic Privilege

Just as Prince Casatti voluntarily renounced his royal birthright to the High Throne to pursue empirical truth, Katrina actively flees her aristocratic heritage in **House Jaren**—one of the wealthiest noble families on the Royal Court. She refuses to be bartered as a diplomatic pawn in court intrigues.

4.4.2. Merit Over Pedigree

Casatti founded The Academy because he believed understanding the cosmos required objective observation rather than imperial decree. Katrina seeks the **Adventurers' Guild**, a frontier brotherhood where practical grit, swordsmanship, and survival skills outweigh bloodlines and heraldic crests.

4.4.3. Surgical Severance for Justice

Casatti infused the Sword of Tenebris to execute **Absolute Justice**—slicing through entrenched siege engines to end a seven-year stalemate. Katrina wields the Sword of Tenebris with cynical, irreverent pragmatism, slicing through aristocratic hypocrisy, feudal exploitation (the St. Baron), and provincial inertia.

4.5. The Custom Bearer as Prince Mi-ren (The Steward of Balance)

When the player selects a custom name (`<chosen_name>`), the relics decouple from fixed protagonists, placing the player into the ideological position of **Prince Mi-ren**:

4.5.1. The Overarching Macro-Steward

While Elijah focuses on the military/institutional conspiracy of the Royal Guard, and Katrina navigates the underground rebellion of the Guild, the Custom Bearer holds **The Dream Compass**, navigating the astral tides of The Dreamscape exclusively at night.

4.5.2. Bearing the Weight of Synthesis

To achieve completion, the Custom Bearer must perform the "double work" along the `[-100, +100]` **Moral Sway** continuum, catching fragments of both Elijah's and Katrina's paths. They stand where Mi-ren stood during the 7-Year Great War: attempting to hold a fracturing world together through reconciliation.

4.5.3. The Burden of Stasis vs. True Equilibrium

The Custom Bearer faces Mi-ren's original dilemma. They can succumb to the **Benevolent Stasis** ending—freezing Sacyra in a protective golden barrier where no growth can occur—or they can transcend Mi-ren's mistake by mending the planar tear in the Room of Sages, reconciling the ancient wound of Usuru, and unlocking the **Secret Chronicler True Ending**.

4.6. The Butterfly Effect vs. The Bystander Corridor: Overriding Cyclic Fate

The thematic axiom **"Trauma is Inherited, Destiny is Chosen"** is not merely a narrative motto; it is a systemic law operating across the `[-100, +100]` Moral Sway axis:

4.6.1. The Bystander Corridor (`[-50, +50]`) as Karmic Determinism

Floating within `[-50, +50]` represents **Net Moral Inertia**, where opposing virtuous and selfish acts cancel out into zero displacement. In this corridor, diffusion of responsibility preserves the status quo: - Elijah is dragged into Usuru's bitter, disillusioned path upon discovering King Jihad's treason. - Katrina is locked into cynical detachment, abandoning Sacyra's rotting court to survive on the margins. - Sacyra's 3,000-year dynastic stasis repeats endlessly because ordinary citizens refuse to risk conviction.

4.6.2. The Butterfly Effect: Micro-Choices as Fate Breakers

Derived from chaos theory, tiny perturbations in initial conditions compound nonlinearly into radically divergent macro-states: - Seemingly modest provincial choices in Dio Village—donating 500 Gold to cover Eric the Lumberjack's taxes, intervening between John the Thief and the predatory St. Baron, or choosing non-lethal shield stagger (**Lux Barrio**) over lethal execution—act as wings flapping against 3,000 years of karmic momentum. - By accumulating deliberate micro-interventions, the party crosses the ± 50 conviction threshold, overriding spiritual reincarnation and proving that while trauma is inherited, destiny is chosen.

Chapter 5. Socio-Political Strata of the Kingdom of Sacyra

Source File: `docs/lore/characters.adoc`

5.1. Overview

This document provides complete biographical dossiers, martial doctrines, and thematic arcs for the central protagonists and key figures of **Tenebris and Lux** in the **Kingdom of Sacyra** and **The Dreamscape**. Grounded in the recovered 2017–2018 demo baseline and the Past/Present/Future thematic triad ("Trauma is Inherited, Destiny is Chosen"), it establishes the tri-perspective narrative architecture across Elijah Ro-enheart, Lady Katrina Jaren, and the Custom Bearer (`<chosen_name>`).

5.2. Elijah Ro-enheart (The Aegis of Lineage)

> "My father taught me that a shield is not a wall to hide behind, but a promise made to the people standing behind you."
>
> — Elijah Ro-enheart

5.2.1. Biography & Heritage

- **Full Name:** Elijah Ro-enheart
- **Affiliation:** Kingdom of Sacyra Royal Army (Cadet Vanguard); House Ro-enheart
- **Family Lineage:** The Ro-enhearts have served the Sacyran crown for five unbroken generations. Elijah's father, **Commander Gareth Ro-enheart**, was the esteemed former Head of the Royal Guard, famed for holding the Sunken Citadel. Gareth vanished under mysterious royal orders on Elijah's **10th birthday**, leaving behind unhealed questions and immense expectations.
- **Upbringing:** Raised in the barracks and training quadrangles of the capital citadel, but spends his youth in **Dio Village** under the watchful care of **Grandma Magolia**.
- **Visual Profile:** Broad-shouldered, athletic build, steel-blue eyes, and cropped dark hair. Wears fitted silver-steel infantry plate over deep navy quilted gambeson, marked with the defensive crest of the Ro-enhearts.

5.2.2. Thematic Parallel: Mirror of Ancient Usuru

Although Elijah wields the Shield of Lux, his personal arc directly mirrors **Usuru** (The Frontier Wound): * **The Boy from the Forgotten Border:** Usuru grew up in neglected Libira; Elijah grows up in neglected Dio Village. * **The Tenth-Year Fracture:** Usuru had ten years of innocent devotion before his world shattered in year 11; Elijah's childhood froze on his 10th birthday when his father vanished. * **Redemption Over Vengeance:** Confronting King Jihad's betrayal, Elijah refuses to burn the kingdom down. He raises the Shield of Lux to protect the living, representing Usuru granted a second chance at moral redemption.

5.2.3. Combat & Tactical Doctrine (TRPG)

- **Battlefield Role (Grid):** Frontline Heavy Vanguard / Fortress Anchor.
- **Grid Attributes:** Heavy physical mitigation, high poise, Zone of Control (ZOC) bottleneck denial, ally interception.
- **Tactical Signature:** `Lux Barrio` — Manifests a radiant geometric barrier dome ($2\dots5$ turn duration, 25% damage mitigation).

5.3. Katrina Jaren (The Blade of Freedom)

> "Silk dresses and court etiquette won't turn back a vanguard blade. Let my cousins argue over tax registries; my place is on the frontier."
>
> — Katrina Jaren

5.3.1. Biography & Heritage

- **Full Name:** Lady Katrina Jaren
- **Affiliation:** House Jaren (Aristocracy of Sacyra); Aspirant of the Adventurers' Guild
- **Family Lineage: House Jaren** is an ancient, wealthy noble family commanding lucrative vineyards and silver mines in Sacyra's eastern provinces, holding significant patronage leverage on the Royal Court.
- **Upbringing:** Groomed by diplomats and heralds to occupy a ceremonial court seat, Katrina despised courtly hypocrisy, frequently escaping to Dio Village and training with Adventurers' Guild rangers.
- **Visual Profile:** Agile, athletic build, sharp amber eyes, and unbound chestnut hair tied in a practical combat braid. Clad in tailored lightweight leather arming doublets over noble-weave tunic, with rapier and long-dagger scabbards.

5.3.2. Thematic Parallel: Mirror of Prince Casatti

Katrina carries the Sword of Tenebris and embodies the philosophy of **Prince Casatti** (The Renouncing Blade): * **Renouncing Aristocratic Birthright:** Just as Casatti renounced the High Throne, Katrina flees House Jaren. * **Merit Over Pedigree:** Casatti founded The Academy for empirical truth; Katrina seeks the Adventurers' Guild where practical survival and skill outweigh heraldic crests. * **Surgical Severance:** Wields the Sword of Tenebris with sharp, cynical candor to slice through court corruption, feudal extortion (the St. Baron), and provincial stagnation.

5.3.3. Combat & Tactical Doctrine (TRPG)

- **Battlefield Role (Grid):** High-Mobility Skirmisher / Flanking Striker.
- **Grid Attributes:** 4–5 cell movement, ignores basic ZOC delays, backstab criticals, hit-and-run disengagement.
- **Tactical Signature:** `Cuttatio Tenebris` — Striking primary target while inflicting 20% splash cleave to adjacent enemy units.

5.4. The Custom Bearer (`<chosen_name>` — The Secret Chronicler)

5.4.1. The Third Perspective: Mirror of Prince Mi-ren

When the player customizes their protagonist name via `name <str>`, the relics decouple from fixed identities, placing the player into the ideological position of **Prince Mi-ren** (The Steward of Balance): * **Macro-Steward of the Veil:** Holds **The Dream Compass**, entering The Dreamscape exclusively during nocturnal windows (`20:00 ⇐ hour || hour ⇐ 04:00`). * **The "Double Work" of Synthesis:** Navigates the `[-100, +100]` Moral Sway continuum to weave fragments of both Elijah's military investigation and Katrina's underground rebellion. * **Resolving the Stasis Fallacy:** Must avoid repeating Mi-ren's ancient error (Benevolent Stasis) to unlock the **Secret Chronicler True Ending**, reconciling the ancient wound of Usuru and permanently mending the planar tear.

5.5. Antagonists & The Two-Half Campaign

5.5.1. King Jihad (The Sovereign of Ambition — Act I Antagonist)

- **Office:** Reigning Monarch of Sacyra, commanding the Royal Guard.
- **Role:** The grotesque inverse of the Founding Dynasty. Imposes state censorship on border warnings and seeks to usurp void power for total dominion.
- **The Possession:** Sitting on the High Throne above the ancient planar wound, Jihad's megalomania inverts the conduit, allowing a dormant remnant of Usuru (**The Dark Lord**) to possess him at the Act I climax.

5.5.2. The Dark Lord (Usuru's Descent — Act II Antagonist)

- **Canonical Identity:** The ancient Libiran youth **Usuru**, whose faith in the Crown was shattered during the 11th Festival.
- **Role:** The overarching existential shadow ("The A Plot") menacing Sacyra from the subterranean Abyssal Vaults.
- **The Final Confrontation:** In Act II, heroes must penetrate the cosmic threshold. Slaying him blindly produces the Neutral Ending; achieving the **Stance of Equilibrium** (**Duo-Loca Bashin n Slash**) severs his abyssal tether while absorbing planar fallout without dissipating, granting Usuru eternal rest.

Chapter 6. The Six Powers of the Continent

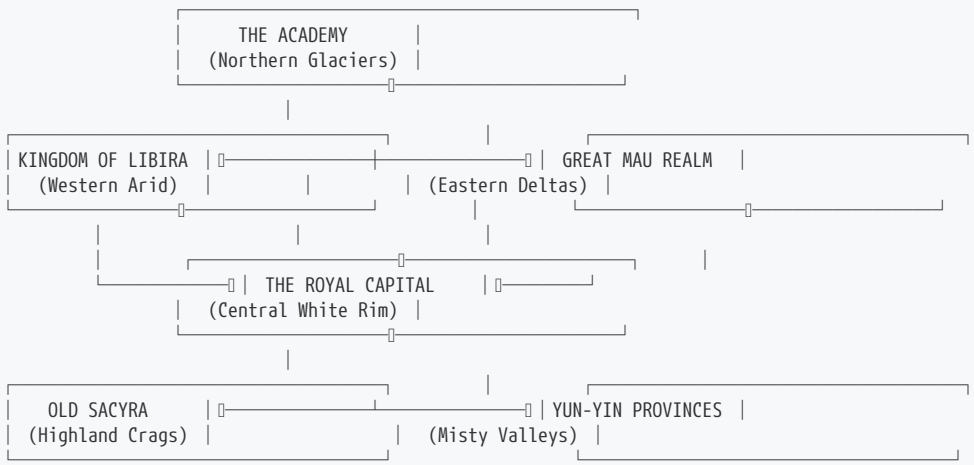
Source File: `docs/lore/realms/the_six_powers.adoc`

6.1. Overview

The historical landscape of **Tenebris and Lux** was shaped by the clash and eventual reconciliation of **The Six Powers** during Eras IV through VI. When the planar rupture during the 11th Festival of Peoples shattered the First King's Pax Sacyrana, Usuru rallied these disparate sovereign nations into the catastrophic **Seven-Year Great War**. Understanding the cultural, architectural, and military profile of each power is essential to comprehending the ancestral factions, regional alliances, and diplomatic endings available within the TRPG campaign.

> No single crown shall claim the sun, and no lone throne shall command the shadows. Six thrones bled upon the salt and marble; six thrones shall swear that the realm shall be joint in peace, yet separate in kingdom, so long as the stars circle the spindle.
>
> — The Accord of Kings, Preamble - Inscribed upon the Six Obelisks of Unity

6.2. Geopolitical Map & Sovereign Overview



6.3. Comprehensive Profiles of the Six Powers

6.3.1. The Royal Capital of Sacyra (The Radiant Center)

- **Domain & Geography**: The fertile central plains and plateaus surrounding the White Rim Citadel.
- **Cultural Philosophy**: Monarchy, institutional duty, legalism, and devotion to the light of the First King.
- **Military Doctrine**: Heavy vanguard infantry, phalanx formations, and divine warding priests wielding the techniques of the **Shield of Lux**.
- **Key Figure**: King Jihad (Present Era); Prince Mi-ren (Founding Era).

6.3.2. The Kingdom of Libira (The Arid Frontier)

- **Domain & Geography**: The harsh western desert canyons, sandstone mesas, and salt flats.

- **Cultural Philosophy**: Radical communal self-reliance, stoic endurance, and fierce resentment of centralized royal arrogance ("The Quiet Complaint").
- **Military Doctrine**: Agile camel skirmishers, desert outriders, and shadow assassins who pioneered the early stances of the **Sword of Tenebris**.
- **Key Figure**: Usuru the Wanderer (The Dark Lord).

6.3.3. The Great Mau Kingdom (The Merchant Empire of the East)

- **Domain & Geography**: The sprawling eastern river deltas, rich alluvial floodplains, and bustling port cities.
- **Cultural Philosophy**: Mercantilism, contract law, civic guilds, and wealth accumulation. To the Mau, war is an economic calculation rather than an ideological crusade.
- **Military Doctrine**: Mercenary phalanxes, river ironclad barges, and repeating crossbowmen funded by the grand banking cartels.
- **Role in the Great War**: Financed Usuru's coalition armies in exchange for mining rights in Libira, switching sides at the midpoint when Sacyra offered trade tariff exemptions.

6.3.4. Old Sacyra (The Highland Ancestral Cradle)

- **Domain & Geography**: The sheer mountain peaks and pine forests north of the Sacyran river valley.
- **Cultural Philosophy**: Strict aristocratic traditionalism, ancestral veneration, and genealogical pride. View the modern Royal Capital as degenerate upstarts who diluted pure Sacyran blood.
- **Military Doctrine**: Mountain rangers, greatsword shock troops, and heavy cavalry capable of fighting on steep inclines.
- **Role in the Great War**: Joined Usuru early to punish the Capital, but broke away when Usuru unleashed uncontrollable void constructs into mortal villages.

6.3.5. The Academy (The Spire of Pure Reason)

- **Domain & Geography**: The frozen northern tundras and geothermal volcanic springs.
- **Cultural Philosophy**: Scientism, arcanotech experimentation, and the empirical dissection of cosmic forces. Reject both religious worship of Lux and superstitious fear of Tenebris.
- **Military Doctrine**: Alchemical siege engines, elemental clockwork automata, and crystal-resonance artillery.
- **Role in the Great War**: Remained neutral for five years before joining the coalition to study the abyssal tear firsthand, later contributing the mathematical formulas used to draft the **Accord of Kings**.

6.3.6. The Yun-yin Provinces (The Valleys of Mist & Wind)

- **Domain & Geography**: The subtropical southeastern archipelago and bamboo cloud forests.
- **Cultural Philosophy**: Spiritual harmony, ki manipulation, cyclical flow, and the balance of dualities. Understood the metaphysical neutrality of darkness long before Sacyran theologians.
- **Military Doctrine**: Martial artists, wind-runners, and agile spear masters using evasion and counter-poise redirection.
- **Role in the Great War**: Sided with Usuru to restore balance against Sacyra's overbearing expansionism, ultimately brokering the peace conference that created the **Joint Realm, Separate Kingdoms** doctrine.

6.4. The Accord of Kings: "Joint Realm, Separate Kingdoms"

Following seven years of devastating continental slaughter, the exhausted sovereigns met upon the neutral plains of the Central Marches to sign the historic **Accord of Kings**:

Article	Diplomatic Covenant & Systemic Law
Article I: Mutual Sovereignty	Each of the Six Powers maintains complete legislative, military, and economic autonomy within their borders.
Article II: The Joint Ward	Sacyra's Royal Guard is legally entrusted with guarding the central rift beneath the High Throne, but may never station troops within foreign realms without consent.
Article III: The Free Caravan	Courier and trade routes between all six nations are declared sacrosanct, guaranteeing that no province may be starved through communication blockade.



In the modern era, King Jihad's clandestine efforts to annex the frontier and resurrect the centralized empire violate the fundamental tenets of the Accord of Kings, providing the political justification for the party's multi-ending divergence.

Chapter 7. Realm Chronicle: The Kingdom of Libira

Source File: `docs/lore/realms/kingdom_of_libira.adoc`

7.1. Overview

The **Kingdom of Libira** is a remote, windswept, and arid frontier realm situated far to the west across the Great Salt Basin, a full seven-day courier journey from the **Royal Capital of Sacyra**. Lacking a fortified relay outpost system throughout the founding era, Libira became the birthplace of the simmering socio-political grievance known historically as **"The Quiet Complaint"**. It was here that a nameless boy was born to a humble shepherd family, traveled the continent as the Three-Day Wanderer, and returned across the warped desert passes as **Usuru**, sovereign of the broken crown and the future **Dark Lord**.

> The sun burns the rocks by day, and the wind freezes the sands by night. Sacyra has water, gold, and songs for its kings. Libira has only stone, salt, and the memory of every empty wagon that never returned from the capital.
>
> — Old Libiran Nomad Proverb, Inscribed upon an Adobe Cistern

7.2. Geography, Climate & The 7-Day Courier Chasm

- **Geographical Classification**: High-altitude arid plateau, red sandstone mesas, salt flats, and canyon wadis.
- **The Communication Gap**:
  - Distance: A full week (seven days) of hard riding by swift couriers across barren terrain.
  - Absence of Infrastructure: Because Libira was historically treated as an unestablished border territory, the Sacyran crown never invested in a chain of relay watchtowers or horse stations.
  - The Warped Rift: When the 11th Festival ritual collapsed, the spatial fabric between Libira and the capital expanded violently, turning a week-long journey into an impassable spatial wasteland.

Dimension	Specification
Terrain Profile	Crimson sand dunes, deep sandstone ravines, dry limestone dry-washes.
Settlement Pattern	Clustered adobe townships built around subterranean aquifers and ancient cisterns.
Key Settlements	**The Assembly of Libira** (Central adobe council citadel); **Wadi Usuru**.
Strategic Resources	Saltpeter, red iron ore, draught lizards, subterranean aquifer water.

7.3. Socio-Political Philosophy: The "Quiet Complaint"

Unlike open rebellions driven by greedy warlords, Libira's grievance was born of profound, generational neglect:

- **The Disconnect**: The capital celebrated annual harvests and imperial festivals, issuing royal edicts that arrived in Libira weeks after decrees were signed. Libiran citizens suffered under droughts and border raids without receiving imperial military reinforcement.
- **The "Quiet Complaint"**: A cultural attitude of stoic, bitter endurance. Libirans learned never to expect salvation from the Crown, fostering fierce communal solidarity and deep suspicion of ceremonial authority.

- **Modern Parallels in Dio Village**: The same dynamic repeats in the present era in **Dio Village**, where Grandma Magolia sighs over the Crown's neglect and the St. Baron taxes commoners without providing protection from monster raids.

> In the narrative architecture of **Tenebris and Lux**, Libira represents the raw root of all conflict. Had the First King's court listened to the nameless boy's petition and built a simple relay road, the Seven-Year Great War would never have occurred.

7.4. The Tragedy of Usuru's Assembly

When Usuru returned from the capital with his skin burned by radiant energy and his eyes alight with abyssal fury, the Libiran Assembly Hall became the focal point of continental history:

1. **The Gathering of Elders**: Tribal elders, weary of decades of unanswered petitions, wept as the youth recounted how the Sacyran guards struck him down simply for asking for roads.
2. **The Acclamation of the Sovereign**: For the first time in their history, the disparate nomadic clans united, placing the iron circlet upon Usuru's brow and naming him their young King.
3. **The Call to the 6 Powers**: Leveraging trade routes across the salt flats, Usuru sent emissaries to Great Mau, Old Sacyra, and the Yun-yin Provinces, turning a localized frontier petition into a world-spanning coalition war.

7.5. Tactical Grid Battlefield: The Red Sandstone Wadi

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 [0]   [1]   [2]   [3]   [4]   [5]   [6]   [7]
┌──────┬──────┬──────┬──────┬──────┬──────┬──────┬──────┐
│ MESA │ MESA │      │ CSTN │ CSTN │      │ MESA │ MESA │ [0] Ancient Cistern (`CSTN`) / High Mesa
├──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┤
│ MESA │ SAND │ SAND │ USURU│ LIBR1│ LIBR2│ SAND │ MESA │ [1] Libiran Skirmishers & Camel Cavalry
├──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┤
│      │ SAND │ DUNE │ DUNE │ DUNE │ SAND │      │      │ [2] Shifting Sand Dunes (Movement Penalty)
├──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┤
│      │ HERO1│ HERO2│ HERO3│ ALLY │      │      │      │ [3] Sacyran Expeditionary Force
├──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┤
│ CANYN│ CANYN│      │ ROAD │ ROAD │      │ CANYN│ CANYN│ [4] Canyon Gorge Chokepoint
└──────┴──────┴──────┴──────┴──────┴──────┴──────┴──────┘
```

7.5.1. Battlefield Invariants

1. **Shifting Dunes (`DUNE`)**: Reduces movement range by 1 tile for heavy armor units (e.g. Elijah).
2. **Canyon Gorges (`CANYN`)**: Impassable chasms; units knocked back into chasms suffer instant fall defeat.
3. **High Sandstone Mesas (`MESA`)**: High ground granting $+25\%$ critical chance to Libiran bowmen.

Chapter 8. Realm Chronicle: The Royal Capital of Sacyra

Source File: `docs/lore/realms/the_royal_capital.adoc`

8.1. Overview

The **Royal Capital of Sacyra** is the administrative, spiritual, and military apex of the kingdom. Crowned by the gleaming white-stone bastions of the **High Throne Citadel**, the city embodies the architectural zenith of Era I's founding dynasties. Yet beneath its ceremonial grandeur, opulent marble halls, and courtly pageantry lies a festering metaphysical wound: **The King's Curse**, an unhealed planar rupture beneath the throne room floor that has leaked abyssal corruption for three millennia, steadily eroding the sanity of **King Jihad**.

> We wash the marble with lavender and rosewater, but the stones remember the blood. When the sun reaches its zenith, the shadow of the throne does not fall toward the door—it falls inward, pooling like dark oil around the King's feet. He smiles at the envoys, but his teeth are gray. Sacyra is dancing upon the lid of a tomb.
>
> — High Priest Roté, Royal Sanctum Secret Journal

8.2. Geography, Architecture & Urban Districts

- **Topographical Location**: Built upon the central continental plateau overlooking the Sacyran river basin.
- **Access Routes**: Reached via the Grand Imperial Causeway traversing the **Sacyran Marches**.
- **Architectural Style**: Monolithic white limestone, soaring arched flying buttresses, gilded radiant domes, and deep subterranean catacombs dating back to the Accord of Kings.

District	Description & Socio-Political Function
The Citadel Ward	The innermost fortress housing the High Throne, the Royal Council Chambers, and the private quarters of King Jihad.
The Aristocratic Quarter	Palatial townhouse estates of the Great Noble Houses (including House Jaren); seat of courtly intrigue and political scheming.
The Grand Cathedral of Lux	Spiritual center governed by High Priest Roté, where the sacred relics are celebrated and celestial portents are interpreted.
The Lower River Ward	Densely packed commoner quarter, guildhalls, iron forges, and the local headquarters of the **Adventurers' Guild**.
The Subterranean Vaults	Forbidden pre-dynastic catacombs directly beneath the throne, site of the 11th Festival Rupture.

8.3. Lore & The King's Curse Planar Wound

During the 11th Festival of Peoples, the young Libiran wanderer Usuru accidentally struck the ritual focus stone during the First King's communion ritual. The resulting explosion severed the First King's soul and cracked the bedrock beneath the dais:

1. **The Hidden Rupture**: The First 30 Kings sealed the physical chamber beneath massive basalt slabs inscribed with warding runes, building the High Throne directly over the scar to mask its presence.
2. **The 3,000-Year Dynastic Wave**: Every monarch who sat upon the High Throne was bathed in the slow, imperceptible radiation of the planar breach. While strong-willed sovereigns resisted its whispers, weak or ambitious rulers inevitably succumbed to paranoia and tyrannical megalomania.
3. **The Possession of King Jihad**: In the present era, King Jihad's obsession with matching the legendary military feats of his ancestors drove him to open the basalt seal. Tenebrous vapor now directly commands the monarch's nervous system, transforming him into an unwitting puppet of **The Dark Lord**.



> The planar wound beneath the High Throne is not merely a narrative backdrop—it serves as the **Midpoint Campaign Fork** in the ludological engine. Entering the throne room without the **Dream Compass** triggers the tragic **Neutral Path**, whereas possessing the calibrated compass allows the party to expose the curse and enter the **True Ending Path**.

8.4. Factions & Urban Intrigue

The Capital is torn between four competing power structures:

- **The Royal Guard**: Commanded by hardline royalists loyal to the throne, increasingly bewildered by King Jihad's erratic and tyrannical decrees.
- **House Jaren & The High Nobles**: Aristocratic court faction maneuvering to consolidate tax monopolies and replace the Ro-enhearts' military influence.
- **The High Priesthood**: Church hierarchy caught between religious dogma and High Priest Roté's terrifying revelations regarding the cosmic corruption of the Crown.
- **The Adventurers' Guild**: Underground network of commoner veterans and sympathizers (including Katrina Jaren) operating outside royal law to protect the citizenry from unexplained void manifestations.

8.5. Tactical Grid Battlefield: The High Throne Chamber

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 [0]   [1]   [2]   [3]   [4]   [5]   [6]   [7]
┌───────┬───────┬───────┬───────┬───────┬───────┬───────┬───────┬──────────────────────────────────────────┐
│ PILLR │ DAIS  │ THRNE │ VOIDC │ THRNE │ DAIS  │ PILLR │ WALL  │ [0] High Dais / The Planar Wound (`VOIDC`)
├───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼──────────────────────────────────────────┤
│ STEPS │ STEPS │ JIHAD │ GUARD │ GUARD │ STEPS │ STEPS │       │ [1] Royal Guard Phalanx
├───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼──────────────────────────────────────────┤
│ CARP  │ CARP  │ CARP  │ CARP  │ CARP  │ CARP  │ CARP  │ CARP  │ [2] Crimson Carpet Center Aisle
├───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼───────┼──────────────────────────────────────────┤
│ PILLR │       │ HERO1 │ HERO2 │ HERO3 │       │ PILLR │       │ [3] Player Party Infiltration Entry
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│ DOOR  │ DOOR  │ DOOR  │ DOOR  │ DOOR  │ DOOR  │ DOOR  │ DOOR  │ [4] Grand Audience Chamber Entrance
└───────┴───────┴───────┴───────┴───────┴───────┴───────┴───────┴──────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

8.5.1. Battlefield Invariants

1. **The Planar Wound (`VOIDC`)**: Generates an aura of -15 HP decay per turn to all units standing within a 2-cell radius unless protected by **Lux Barrio**.
2. **Marble Pillars (`PILLR`)**: Provide heavy cover ($+30\%$ evasion against ranged magic).
3. **Royal Dais Steps (`STEPS`)**: Units attacking upward suffer a -15% accuracy penalty.

Chapter 9. Realm Chronicle: The Sacyran Marches

Source File: `docs/lore/realms/sacyra_marches.adoc`

9.1. Overview

The **Sacyran Marches** (`LOC_SACYRA_MARCHES`) encompass the windswept limestone hills, fortified military outposts, and ancient battlefields stretching between the **Whispering Woods** and the white-stone bastions of the **Royal Capital**. Established during the Seven-Year Great War as the kingdom's primary defensive perimeter, the Marches serve as the tactical proving ground where the player transitions from local woodland skirmishes to large-scale military engagements.

> The Marches are where boyish dreams of glory die and real soldiers are forged. The wind here carries no warmth—only dust, iron, and the perpetual vigilance of men who know that if these ridges fall, nothing stands between the abyss and our homes.
>
> — Commander Gareth Ro-enheart, Field Dispatch - Frontier Fortress Redoubt

9.2. Geography & Strategic Topology

- **Location Identifier**: `LOC_SACYRA_MARCHES` (Integer index `3` in `location_id_t`).
- **Territorial Domain**: Central border province linking southern farmlands with the high plateaus.
- **Topographical Neighbors**:
  - **West / South**: Slopes gently downward into the canopy of the **Whispering Woods**.
  - **North / East**: Connects directly to the grand paved highway leading to the **Royal Capital**.
- **Terrain Features**: Terraced limestone plateaus, fortified palisades, stone watchtowers, and deep defensive trenches left behind by centuries of border warfare.

Dimension	Specification
Ambient Threat Level	High ($110–140$ Threat Rating).
Weather Phenomena	High-altitude gale winds, dry squalls, sudden dust storms reducing vision.
Strategic Redoubts	**Tower of the Sunken Citadel** (Gareth Ro-enheart's former garrison).
Factional Influence	Royal Guard Vanguard, Frontier Mercenary Guild, Shadow Host Infiltrators.

9.3. Lore & The Legacy of the 7-Year Great War

During the Seven-Year Great War (approximately 3,000 years ago), Usuru's coalition forces launched their primary armored spearhead across these very hills. The earth of the Marches remains soaked in residual abyssal and radiant energies:

- **The Trenches of the First 30 Kings**: Deep geometric trenches dug into the chalk hills to funnel void automata into kill zones.
- **The Sunken Citadel**: A subterranean fortress carved into the limestone bedrock where Commander Gareth Ro-enheart made his legendary stand before his mysterious disappearance following Elijah's 10th birthday.

- **The Broken Standards**: Decaying heraldic banners of ancient kingdoms (Great Mau, Libira, Old Sacyra) still flutter from iron spires atop the limestone ridges.



The Marches are the first location where the player encounters organized military opposition rather than mindless wild beasts. Enemies employ tactical formations, archery volleys, and coordinated flanking maneuvers.

9.4. Field Bestiary & Combat Formations

Hostile Unit	HP / DEF	Flank Vigor	Tactical Discipline & Threat Profile
Shadow Scout	110 HP / 18 DEF	80 Vigor	High speed outrider; marks targets for ranged volleys.
Vanguard Patrol	160 HP / 26 DEF	90 Vigor	Heavy shield infantry; projects Zone of Control.
Abyssal Ballista	220 HP / 30 DEF	20 Vigor	Siege construct; fires armor-piercing void bolts.



Vanguard Patrols utilize **Phalanx Formations** that reduce frontal physical damage by 40%. Players must utilize Katrina's high movement mobility or the Custom Bearer's **Edge Striking** stance to maneuver behind their line for decisive backstabs.

9.5. Tactical Grid Battlefield: The Palisade Ridge

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┌─────┬─────┬─────┬─────┬─────┬─────┬─────┬─────┬──────────────────────────────┐
│TWR_N│WALL │GATE │GATE │WALL │WALL │TWR_E│HILL │ [0] North -> High Road to Capital
├─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼──────────────────────────────┤
│RAMP │RAMP │SCOUT│VANG1│VANG2│SCOUT│RAMP │HILL │ [1] Defensive Line
├─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼──────────────────────────────┤
│TRENCH     │     │     │     │     │TRENCH     │ [2] Muddy Trench (Movement Penalty)
├─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼──────────────────────────────┤
│     │HERO1│HERO2│ALLY1│ALLY2│     │     │     │ [3] Player Assault Vanguard
├─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼─────┼──────────────────────────────┤
│     │ROAD │ROAD │ROAD │ROAD │     │     │     │ [4] South -> Whispering Woods
└─────┴─────┴─────┴─────┴─────┴─────┴─────┴─────┴──────────────────────────────┘
```

9.5.1. Battlefield Mechanics

1. **Elevated Ramparts (`RAMP`)**: Grants ranged units $+1$ Attack Range and $+20\%$ Physical Defense.
2. **Muddy Trench (`TRENCH`)**: Costs $2.5\times$ movement points to traverse and prevents defensive parries.
3. **Iron Gate (`GATE`)**: Destructible obstacle (150 HP) that must be breached or bypassed via flanking ladders.

Chapter 10. Realm Chronicle: The Whispering Woods

Source File: `docs/lore/realms/whispering_woods.adoc`

10.1. Overview

The **Whispering Woods** (`LOC_WHISPERING_WOODS`) form an ancient, dense primeval canopy encircling **Dio Village**, separating the peaceful hamlet from the windswept frontier of the **Sacyran Marches**. Named for the haunting acoustic phenomenon produced by autumn winds filtering through hollow ironwood boughs, the forest serves as the player's first physical wilderness trial after awakening from **The Dreamscape**.

> Those woods were quiet when my grandfather worked the timber. Now, you can't walk twenty paces off the road without hearing shadows moving in the thicket. Something deep in the capital is leaking into the roots.
>
> — Eric the Lumberjack, Dio Village Timber Yard

10.2. Geography & Environmental Atmosphere

- **Location Identifier**: `LOC_WHISPERING_WOODS` (Integer index `2` in `location_id_t`).
- **Territorial Domain**: Southwestern province of the Kingdom of Sacyra.
- **Topographical Neighbors**:
  - **South**: Borders the agricultural plots and timber yards of **Dio Village**.
  - **North & East**: Ascends into the crags and signal hills of the **Sacyran Marches**.
- **Flora & Terrain**: Gnarled ironwood trunks, glowing amber fungi, thick moss carpets, and narrow cobblestone paths choked by invasive briers and fallen timber.

Dimension	Realm Specification
Ambient Threat Level	Moderate ($70–90$ Threat Rating).
Weather Phenomena	Morning autumn mist; nocturnal veil thinning; ambient whisper reverberation.
Sanctuary Nodes	The Forester's Shrine (Campfire rest point; restores 100% MP).
Resource Harvest	Ironwood logs, Sacyran belladonna herbs, glowing resonant spores.

10.3. Lore & Ancient Secrets

Local Sacyran folklore claims the woods were planted by Prince Casatti during his frontier expeditions to serve as a natural barrier shielding the commoners from imperial court politics. Beneath the dense root network lie forgotten stone markers from Era I, indicating that the forest grew atop an ancient tectonic fault line directly connected to the abyssal fissure beneath the Royal Capital.

Archival Marginalia: The Soughing Boughs

When night falls across the canopy, travelers report hearing murmurs that sound like voices debating in the archaic dialect of Era IV. Scholars from The Academy believe these are acoustic reflections of the First King's sealed

court, vibrating along ley lines from the Dreamscape.

10.4. Bestiary & Field Encounters

Corrupted by ambient abyssal miasma leaking outward from the capital's planar wound, the native fauna of the woods has mutated into predatory shadow beasts:

Hostile Entity	HP / DEF	Flank Vigor	Combat Behavior & Threat Profile
Umbral Wolf	85 HP / 14 DEF	60 Vigor	Pack hunter; attempts coordinated flanking sprints.
Brier Lurker	120 HP / 18 DEF	40 Vigor	Concealed in brambles; inflicts poison and entangle.
Twilight Raven	45 HP / 8 DEF	80 Vigor	High evasion; dives to disrupt casting stances.



Umbral Wolves receive a $+25\%$ attack bonus when attacking from an adjacent flanking tile. Players must anchor their formation using **Lux Barrio** to prevent fragile party members from being isolated.

10.5. Tactical Grid Map Architecture

Combat within the Whispering Woods utilizes dense environmental obstacles and restrictive chokepoints:

```
 [0]   [1]   [2]   [3]   [4]   [5]   [6]   [7]
┌──────┬──────┬──────┬──────┬──────┬──────┬──────┬──────┬──────────────────────────────┐
│ TREE │ TREE │      │ PATH │ PATH │      │ TREE │ TREE │ [0] North -> Sacyran Marches │
├──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────────────────────────────┤
│ TREE │BRIER │      │      │WOLF1 │      │BRIER │ TREE │ [1]                          │
├──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────────────────────────────┤
│      │      │ ROCK │      │      │WOLF2 │      │      │ [2] Chokepoint Corridor      │
├──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────────────────────────────┤
│ PATH │ PATH │      │HERO1 │HERO2 │      │ PATH │ PATH │ [3] Player Vanguard Deployment │
├──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────┼──────────────────────────────┤
│ TREE │      │ SHRN │ PATH │ PATH │      │      │ TREE │ [4] South -> Dio Village     │
└──────┴──────┴──────┴──────┴──────┴──────┴──────┴──────┴──────────────────────────────┘
```

10.5.1. Environmental Grid Invariants

1. **Tree & Granite Rock Obstacles**: Completely block line-of-sight and unit transit.
2. **Dense Brier Patches**: Inflict $2.0\times$ movement cost and -10 HP per step for non-flying units.
3. **Forester's Shrine (`SHRN`)**: Standing adjacent to the shrine grants $+15\%$ Lux warding efficiency.

Chapter 11. Realm Chronicle: Dio Village

Source File: `docs/lore/realms/dio_village.adoc`

11.1. Overview & Pastoral Heritage

Dio Village is a pastoral woodland settlement situated in the southwestern valley frontier of the **Kingdom of Sacyra**. Functioning as the physical inception of the hero's journey upon awakening from **The Dreamscape**, Dio Village serves as the terrestrial anchor of Chapter 1, embodying the modern continuation of ancient Libira's systemic neglect under the 3,000-year dynastic order.

11.2. Socio-Political Role: "The Quiet Complaint" of Modern Sacyra

- **Mirror of Ancient Libira:** Just as ancient Libira suffered a 7-day communication delay and lacked imperial relay outposts, modern Dio Village is neglected under the "Joint Realm, Separate Kingdoms" bureaucracy. As Grandma Magolia sighs in Map 021: *"This town used to be full of life. **sighs** The kingdom doesn't pay much attention to this place anymore..."*.
- **Economic Fragility & Class Exploitation:** While the Capital enjoys insulated peace, Dio Village faces monster outbreaks near the timber lines. **Eric the Lumberjack** faces ruin because monsters block the woods, while the predatory **St. Baron** exploits commoners through exorbitant rents and usury.
- **Gareth Ro-enheart's Shadow:** Dio Village is where Commander Gareth Ro-enheart placed his son Elijah under Grandma Magolia's care before his mysterious disappearance on Elijah's 10th birthday.

11.3. Key Landmarks & Dual-Perspective Quest Hubs

- **Grandma Magolia's Cottage (Maps 020 & 021):** The warm stone hearth where the protagonist awakens. Contains the upstairs chest housing **Grandma's Watch** (activating the Layer 0 monotonic clock).
  - **Elijah's Approach:** Hesitates out of filial respect and family etiquette.
  - **Katrina's Approach:** Seeks the will immediately to escape the dead-end town.
- **Eric's Timber Yard & Test of Honesty (Map 028):** Filling Eric's rent pot shifts Moral Sway positively and rewards the **Ring of Fire**, enabling flame-weave relic embellishments.
- **Monica's Mystic Grove & Lyri's Offering (Maps 023, 027, 029):** Former Royal Battlemage Monica guards the memorial totem of fallen soldiers. Stopping the bandit kid and buying an offering potion for **Lyri, the Goddess of Peace**, attunes the relics to arcane resonance and awards the **Book of Monsters**.
- **The St. Baron's Estate & John the Thief (Maps 030 & 031):** Deciding whether to aid **John the Thief** in robbing the corrupt baron versus upholding feudal property law shapes the penetration or bastion embellishments of the relics.

11.4. Mechanical Role in the C11 Simulation Engine

- **Engine Enumeration:** Registered in `include/sim/sim_types.h` as `LOC_DIO_VILLAGE`.
- **Sanctuary Province:** Zero hostile vigor during standard state; permits inventory management, dialogue interactions, moral compass calibration, and Layer 0 monotonic time passage.
- **Terrestrial Lockout:** Gated throughout Chapter 1, preventing return to The Dreamscape until the acquisition and awakening of **The Dream Compass**.

Chapter 12. Realm Chronicle: The Dreamscape

Source File: `docs/lore/realms/the_dreamscape.adoc`

12.1. Overview & Metaphysical Essence

The Dreamscape (also known as the Astral Substrate or Room of Sages) is an ethereal plane of consciousness, ancestral memory, and timeless trials existing between waking reality and slumber. Grounded in the recovered 2017–2018 demo script (Maps 006, 008, 011, 041, 042) and verified in the ISO C11 engine architecture as `LOC_THE_DREAMSCAPE`, it serves as the cosmological origin point where the protagonist awakens before entering the temporal Kingdom of Sacyra.

12.2. Historical & Metaphysical Provenance

- **The Coma of the First King:** Following the inaugural Festival of Peoples 3,000 years ago, the First King collapsed into a coma. His spirit was found fully lucid and awake inside The Dreamscape. While Prince Mi-ren and Prince Casatti sustained projections for ten festivals, the 11th Festival tampering by Usuru snapped the ethereal tether, permanently sealing the First King's soul here.
- **The Annual Thinning of the Veil:** For one week each year—coinciding with the Festival of Heroes—the boundary ("the Veil") separating the temporal world from The Dreamscape thins to gossamer, allowing mortals to project desires across the threshold.
- **The Three Laws of Crossing the Veil:**
  1. **The Mirror of Intent:** The ether reflects mortal intent. Pure devotion projects harmony; terror, spite, or megalomania (such as King Jihad's treason) inverts the conduit into waking nightmares.
  2. **The Severed Tether:** Sustaining a long bridge across the veil carries fatal risk. Violent interruption snaps spiritual tethers, marooning consciousness permanently.
  3. **The Dream Eater Infiltration:** Tearing or weakening the veil attracts **Dream Eaters**—parasitic entities native to the deep astral voids that devour mortal memories, dreams, and ancestral records.

12.3. Mechanical Integration in the C11 Engine

- **Engine Enumeration:** Registered in `include/sim/sim_types.h` as `LOC_THE_DREAMSCAPE`.
- **Opening Trial:** The protagonist awakens in the Hall of Sages with **Chrono the Sage**, attuning to class archetype stones and testing `Lux Barrio` and `Cuttatio Tenebris` against Dream Eaters before Chrono's command (**"AWAKEN!"**) transports consciousness to Grandma Magolia's hearth in Dio Village.
- **Terrestrial Gating:** Throughout Chapter 1 (the demo), return to The Dreamscape is barred, anchoring the player in terrestrial human stakes.
- **The Dream Compass & Nocturnal Phasing:** Upgraded from Grandma's Watch, the Dream Compass allows entry to The Dreamscape exclusively during nocturnal hours (`20:00 ⇐ hour || hour ⇐ 04:00`).
- **Tactical LeTBS Environments:** Comprises floating platform grids, shifting crystal leylines, and astral mechanisms that restore MP while exposing units to planar shear.

Chapter 13. High School Inception & TRPG Genesis

Source File: `docs/dev_logs/2026/10/lore_and_design/devlog_002_the_sacyra_chronicles_and_trpg_vision.adoc`

13.1. Abstract

This developer log chronicles the foundational provenance and overarching creative vision of **Tenebris and Lux**, rooted in its 2014–2018 high school inception as the premier game project of CreativeWorkzStudio. It documents the elimination of placeholder factions in favor of the canonical **Kingdom of Sacyra**, the introduction of dual protagonists **Elijah Ro-enheart** and **Katrina Jaren**, and the technical specification of the game's true genre: a **Tactical Strategy RPG (TRPG)** fusing grid-based tactical maneuvering with cinematic traditional side-scroll / action-based combat resolution.

13.2. Historical Provenance: The 2014–2018 High School Genesis

Before CreativeWorkzStudio evolved into a multifaceted publishing house, **Tenebris and Lux** was its very first major game in active development.

- **The RPG Maker Era (2014–2018)**: Conceived while the author was in high school learning game design and programming. The initial iterations were built using the default offerings of RPG Maker, exploring community plugins, and crafting characters through its Character Generator.
- **The Lost Assets & The Blank Canvas**: With no legacy digital assets surviving from that era, the project stands not as a nostalgic port, but as a complete ground-up rebirth—realizing the original creative vision with the systems engineering maturity, mathematical rigor, and architectural discipline of modern custom engine design.

13.3. Narrative Realignment: The Kingdom of Sacyra

During early prototype scaffolding, generic placeholder factions ("The Solar Order" and "The Umbral Covenant") were inserted to test basic moral sway logic. On October 26, 2026, the creator firmly realigned the canon, stripping away these synthetic factions to reveal the true world:

13.3.1. The Kingdom of Sacyra (`/s□□□ki□r□/`)

- The setting is the historic **Kingdom of Sacyra** (pronounced **"saw-kee-ruh"**).
- Sacyra is a structured, chivalric realm anchored by three distinct socio-political pillars:
  1. **The Crown & Royal Guard**: Guardians of legal order, national defense, and the ancestral throne.
  2. **The Noble Houses & Royal Court**: High aristocracy governing regional fiefs and vying for political dominance on the royal council.
  3. **The Adventurers' Guild**: A pragmatic, frontier-based brotherhood operating beyond courtly vanity, answering commoner monster distress calls and exploring untamed ruins.
- **The Existential Threat**: The ancient sovereign **The Dark Lord** breaking through the Abyssal Vaults, threatening to extinguish all mortal agency.

13.3.2. The Dual Protagonists

Rather than a generic lone wanderer, the narrative is anchored by two contrasting protagonists whose fates, lineages, and martial philosophies intertwine:

Character	Elijah Ro-enheart	Lady Katrina Jaren
Social Origin	Military Lineage (Common/Barracks Nobility)	High Aristocracy (House Jaren)
Family Heritage	Son of the former Head of the Royal Guard	Daughter of an influential noble house on the Royal Court
Internal Desire	Living up to his father's legendary military legacy while discovering what true honor demands	Escaping stifling aristocratic court expectations to join the local **Adventurers' Guild**
Relic Synergy	**The Shield of Lux** (Sanctuary, Warding, Formation Hold)	**The Sword of Tenebris** (Severance, Mist-Veil, Critical Strike)
TRPG Doctrine	Frontline heavy vanguard; zone-of-control denial; ally interception	Agile outrider skirmisher; bypassing enemy lines; flanking assassin

13.4. Ludological Evolution: The Tactical Strategy RPG (TRPG)

The game's true mechanical identity is a **Tactical Strategy RPG (TRPG)**. This fundamentally informs how the simulation engine and presentation viewports are being constructed:

13.4.1. The Dual-Layer Combat Loop

The combat loop operates across two synchronized phases:

1. **Strategic Grid Phase**:
   - The battle takes place on a discrete 2D grid representing castles, ramparts, thickets, and void-blighted frontier passes.
   - Units position based on movement ranges, terrain defense bonuses, directional facing (Front, Flank, Rear), and Zone-of-Control (ZOC) restrictions.
2. **Cinematic Combat Resolution (Side-View Action)**:
   - When a unit initiates combat against an enemy target, the game transitions into a dynamic **2D traditional side-scroll / action-based clash**.
   - Attacks play out with timed player agency: precision blocks with the Shield of Lux, poise-breaking shield bashes, and devastating severance slashes with the Sword of Tenebris.
   - Upon duel conclusion, remaining unit health, stagger, and relic resonance seamlessly persist back to the tactical grid.

13.4.2. Architectural Implications for the C Engine

Knowing this was originally an RPG Maker project gives us clear architectural directives: * **Decoupled Data Architecture**: Static definitions (`Units`, `Skills`, `Equipment`, `TerrainTypes`) must exist as clean data tables distinct from session state (`player_state_t`, `grid_t`). * **Deterministic Event Pipeline**: Interactive map features (gates, switches, dialog triggers) will follow a clean, reentrant command interpreter model. * **Zero Engine Bloat**: By building this custom in C11 rather than relying on bloated runtimes, our TRPG will maintain sub-millisecond turn updates, instantaneous scene transitions, and absolute softlock immunity.

13.5. Next Milestone Roadmap

1. **Phase 1 (Complete)**: Established OmniCode 5-block layering, Layer 0 utilities, CTest verification suite, and canonical documentation.
2. **Phase 2 (Active)**: Expand simulation state to model dual protagonists (Elijah & Katrina), party data structures, and the foundational 2D tactical grid.
3. **Phase 3**: Implement the cinematic side-scroll combat transition in the presentation layer.
4. **Phase 4**: Expand the tactical campaign across the provinces of Sacyra to confront the vanguard of The Dark Lord.